

A *terminal* is a program that allows you to interact with the OS, and it is often referred to as the *console* or *command line*. You use a terminal (rather than going through a GUI) to issue clear, concise, text-based commands to the OS to quickly perform tasks.

You can run a Python program from a terminal using a command like this:

```
$ python hello_world.py
```

You can also start a Python session in a terminal. In a Python terminal session, each line of code executes as soon as you enter it:

```
$ python  
>>> print("Hello, terminal world!")  
Hello, terminal world!
```